

Plan Before Code (Spec)

Day 17

Lesson 16

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Vibe Coding Bootcamp

Phase 4 — AI as engineer

Time: 60–75 min

Mode: Self-study

Today's goals:

- ★ Write capstone spec
- ★ Split MVP vs nice-to-have
- ★ Practice spec-first AI prompt



Quest map: Day 17 of 22

Hook — why today matters

Today you level up your builder skills.

Big idea



Learn

Spec = inputs, outputs, rules, edge cases. MVP = smallest fun version. Tasks ordered for 3 days.



AI rules today

Prompt: “Here is my spec. Ask 3 questions before code.”



Demo code

Folder: day17/

Open: day17/demos/CAPSTONE_SPEC_TEMPLATE.md

Guided practice



Try it

Open demos/CAPSTONE_SPEC_TEMPLATE.md and copy sections into your spec file.

Assignments



Assignment

Work in: `day17/assignment/`

A — Written List MVP features (3 bullets max).

B — Written List nice-to-have features (2 bullets).

C — Level up Complete `assignment/CAPSTONE_SPEC.md` with 5 tasks for capstone Days 19–21.

D — Explain One MVP example and one nice-to-have from your spec.



Self-study checklist

- ☐ Re-read **Learn**; predict outputs (10 min)
- ☐ Assignments A–D (35–45 min)
- ☐ Run your program 3 times with different inputs
- ☐ 3-bullet “what I tried” note
- ☐ Stuck 15 min → C-R-A-V (`../shared/prompts.md`)

Reflection

1. Easiest vs hardest today?
2. One line you can teach a friend.

Tomorrow: Controlled debugging.